PRATISHTHA KOTHARI
Raleigh, NC | (919) 432-3065 | prati@unc.edu | US Citizen

EDUCATION

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill | B.S. Neuroscience, Expected May 2030
HS GPA (4.712 W)

- Courses -General Chemistry I & II, Intro Biology, Calculus I & II, Intro Economics, Sensation & Perception, Health Humanities
- Clubs/Organizations: Phi Delta Epsilon Medical Fraternity & FlowForward

Awards/Honors

- Park Scholarship (~1% applicants awarded, full merit scholarship)
- HOSA– 1st Place in Health Education (State Level) | Gold Barbara James Service Award (International Level**)**

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Hursting Lab, Dept. of Nutrition | UNC Gillings **Chapel Hill, NC**
Undergraduate Researcher *September 2026 – Present*

- Studying tirzepatide's potential to suppress obesity-linked tumor growth in obese mouse models Conducting mRNA isolation techniques, PCR, electrophoresis, and cell culture.

Cardiometabolic Lab, Dept. of Exercise & Sport Science | UNC **Chapel Hill, NC**
Research Collaborator *June 2025 – August 2026*

- NIH (R01) funded; performed ELISAs, collected blood pressure, ECG, heart rate variability, vascular Doppler ultrasound
- Processed blood samples (centrifugation, aliquoting, storage) for biobanking

Exercise Oncology Research Lab | UNC
Meta-Analysis Contributor *November 2024 – Present*

- Co-authoring a quantitative review of how cancer therapies impact arterial stiffness/cardiovascular risk (e.g. PWV)

PRESENTATIONS & PROJECTS

Southeast American College of Sports Medicine Conference **Greenville, SC**

- Kothari P, et al. "The Impact of Maintaining Knee Flexion on Pulse Wave Velocity Measurements Following Prolonged Sitting." Lead on Poster presentation at annual conference

HOSA – Future Health Professionals *August 2024 – April 2025*
Medical Innovation – MaterniSense

- Led the development and prototyping of a diagnostic pregnancy diaper that tested for preeclampsia, UTI, and gestational diabetes

CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

UNC Health Rex | Orthopedic Unit **Raleigh, NC**
Patient Care Volunteer *June 2023 – May 2026*

- Collaborated in Orthopedic department, managed patient records, assisting with discharge, and delivering/organizing medication

Nurse Aide I | Wake Technical Community College

- Completed 80+ clinical hours at UNC Rex Hospital and Springmoor Life Care Retirement Community

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

Certifications: Certified Nursing Assistant, CPR/AED, Pediatric First Aid, OSHA, HIPAA
Physiology/Clinical: vascular Doppler ultrasound, SphygmoCor PWV, NIRS, ECG, blood pressure, HRV
Languages: Hindi (Conversational/Native), Spanish (Intermediate)
Technical Proficiencies: REDCap, Microsoft Office Suite, Canva, Adobe, Digital Citizenship